

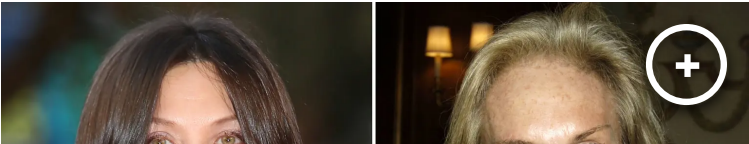
MOVIES EXCLUSIVE

Donna Tartt drops her agent, shocks literary community

By [Emily Smith](#) and [Ian Mohr](#)

Published Nov. 16, 2017, 9:05 p.m. ET

Comments



SECTIONS

TIPS

LOG IN



Donna Tartt and Binky Urban
Getty Images

Get the latest news from Page Six
Click "I'm in" then "Allow" for notifications

No ThanksI'm in

EXPLORE MORE

Author Ana Huang’s favorite books span across all genres

New book reveals how Mick Jagger cheated death twice: ‘Lips were turning blue’

unsung heroes of...

Selena Gomez is the latest star to use this viral K-beauty...

Kate Hudson says

Inside Mick Jagger's messy love life: 'Drug overdoses,' 'affairs' and eight children

Author **Donna Tartt** has left her legendary agent Amanda “Binky” Urban in a move that’s stunned the literary world after Urban landed Tartt a monster \$3 million deal for the movie rights to her blockbuster novel “The Goldfinch.”

Sources tell Page Six that despite all the dough, Tartt was left with a sour taste in her mouth when she was not given the chance to write the screenplay for the film or named as a producer.

A publishing insider tells Page Six of Tartt, who was repped by Urban for three decades: “She was unhappy with the deal made for the movie. Tartt wanted a shot to write it, and that wasn’t given to her — nor was she able to get a producer credit, which seems ludicrous.” The film’s being written by Peter Straughan, who adapted “Wolf Hall” for PBS.

Warner Bros. first snapped up rights to Tartt’s best-seller in 2014, but in August it reached a deal with Amazon Studios to co-finance the film for \$40 million. Around the same time that this deal was made, Tartt left Urban and her agency ICM, defecting to Nicole Aragi at Aragi Inc.

Much of the literati has remained in the dark as to why Tartt left Urban, who’s widely known as one of the most accomplished book agents of all time. “No one seems to know why,” said an insider. “Totally baffling decision. I wish I knew!”

Another source told us, “Even though Binky got



this new anti-aging skin care ‘goes...



Scarlett Johansson’s tennis necklace (and everything else at...



This jewelry brand is Taylor Swift’s (and Travis Kelce’s) goo...

MORE SHOPPING ►

Donna a \$3 million deal, she was upset she didn't secure more control over the film for Donna, as a screenwriter or producer."

Aragi's highbrow clients include Edwidge Danticat, Junot Díaz, Jonathan Safran Foer and Colson Whitehead. But the addition of Tartt may not pay off immediately: She's known to take eight to 10 years to cook up her novels.

Either way, a source said, "Binky only has great things to say about Donna." Urban's clients include Walter Isaacson, Toni Morrison and Cormac McCarthy. An ICM rep said, "Tartt and Urban remain friends and the separation was amicable." Aragi Inc. didn't get back to us.

The movie will star **Ansel Elgort** and **Sarah Paulson**. Brett Ratner was an exec producer — but is out amid his harassment scandal.

FILED UNDER **BOOKS,** **DONNA TARTT,** **11/16/17**

MORE STORIES

Page Six

SECTIONS & FEATURES

[VIDEO](#)

[PHOTOS](#)

NEWSLETTERS & PODCASTS

[EMAIL NEWSLETTERS](#)

[PODCASTS](#)

CONTACT US

[ABOUT PAGE SIX](#)

[EDITORIAL STANDARDS](#)

[TIPS](#)

[ADVERTISE/MEDIA KIT](#)

[SELF SERVICE ADVERTISING](#)

[CONTACT](#)

[LICENSING & REPRINTS](#)

[VULNERABILITY DISCLOSURE PROGRAM](#)

© 2026 NYP Holdings, Inc. All Rights Reserved | [Terms Of Use](#) | [Privacy Notice](#) | [Sitemap](#)

[Your California Privacy Rights](#) | [Do Not Sell or Share My Personal Information](#)